

RKM BANK EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Fictional policy document created for employee-policy training, search, and RAG pipeline testing

1. Purpose and Scope

This Employee Handbook describes the general employment practices of RKM Bank, an imaginary financial institution. It is intended to help employees understand how the Bank approaches hiring, onboarding, workplace expectations, compensation, leave, benefits, employee support, separation, and retirement. The handbook applies to regular full-time and part-time employees unless a section specifically states otherwise. Contractors, consultants, interns, and temporary workers may be governed by separate agreements, although they are expected to follow applicable conduct, security, and confidentiality requirements while working with the Bank.

This handbook is not an employment contract and does not guarantee employment for any fixed period. RKM Bank may revise, suspend, or replace policies when business, legal, regulatory, security, or operational needs change. When a policy is materially changed, Human Resources will normally communicate the new rule through the employee portal or an official announcement. If a local law provides a greater benefit or protection than this handbook, the local law will apply.

1.1 Employment Principles

RKM Bank seeks to maintain a professional, respectful, inclusive, secure, and customer-focused workplace. Employment decisions are based on legitimate business requirements, role qualifications, performance, conduct, and organizational needs. The Bank does not tolerate unlawful discrimination, harassment, retaliation, bribery, falsification of records, theft, misuse of customer information, or deliberate violation of information-security controls.

1.2 Employee Classifications

A regular full-time employee is normally scheduled for at least 35 hours per week and may be eligible for the complete benefits package. A regular part-time employee is normally scheduled for fewer than 35 hours per week and may receive prorated benefits depending on the program. A temporary employee is hired for a defined period or assignment and generally does not receive the same benefits as regular employees unless required by law or specifically approved. An intern is engaged primarily for structured learning and project exposure.

1.3 Work Locations

Depending on the role, an employee may be designated on-site, hybrid, or remote. A work-location designation does not create a permanent entitlement. The Bank may change a role from remote to hybrid or from hybrid to on-site when customer needs, security requirements, collaboration needs, regulatory obligations, or operational conditions require a different arrangement. Employees must keep their primary work location and contact information current in the Human Resources system.

1.4 Questions About Policies

Employees should first contact their manager for ordinary workplace questions. Questions about pay, benefits, leave, accommodations, employment records, or policy interpretation should be directed to Human Resources. Suspected fraud, unethical conduct, retaliation, data misuse, or serious policy violations may be raised through the Ethics and Compliance channel. Good-faith reporting is protected from retaliation.

2. Recruitment, Hiring, and Pre-Employment Process

2.1 Job Requisition and Posting

Hiring normally begins when a department identifies a business need and receives approval for a position. Human Resources confirms the job title, core responsibilities, required skills, employment classification, reporting relationship, work location, and approved compensation range. Positions may be posted internally, externally, or both. Internal employees are encouraged to apply when they meet the stated qualifications and have satisfactory performance and conduct records.

2.2 Application and Screening

Candidates are expected to provide truthful and complete information in applications, resumes, interviews, and supporting documents. Human Resources may screen candidates for minimum education, experience, technical skills, communication ability, professional licenses, and job-specific requirements. Providing materially false information may result in withdrawal of an offer or termination after employment begins.

2.3 Interview Process

The normal interview process may include an initial Human Resources discussion, a hiring-manager interview, one or more technical or functional interviews, and a final discussion about role expectations. Senior, sensitive, financial-control, security, audit, and leadership positions may require additional assessment. Interviewers are expected to evaluate job-related criteria and avoid questions that are prohibited by applicable law.

2.4 Background Verification

Employment offers may be contingent on background verification appropriate to the role and permitted by law. Verification may include identity, prior employment, education, professional credentials, criminal-history review, sanctions screening, and other checks relevant to banking responsibilities. Positions with access to financial systems, customer funds, privileged technology, or sensitive records may be subject to enhanced screening. A candidate will be given any notices or authorization forms required by applicable law.

2.5 Employment Offer

An official offer is valid only when issued through an authorized RKM Bank Human Resources representative or approved electronic system. The offer normally states the job title, manager, starting compensation, work location, intended start date, employment classification, and any conditions that must be satisfied before employment begins. Verbal statements by interviewers do not modify the written offer unless Human Resources confirms the change in writing.

2.6 Internal Transfers and Promotions

Employees who have completed at least six months in their current role may normally apply for internal opportunities, although exceptions may be approved for organizational reasons. Employees with an active final written warning or an unsatisfactory performance rating are generally not eligible for voluntary transfer until the restriction is resolved. Promotions are based on business need, demonstrated capability, sustained performance, readiness for the higher-level responsibilities, and approved headcount.

2.7 Referral Program

The Bank may operate an employee referral program for selected openings. A referral bonus, when offered, is paid only after the referred candidate joins the Bank and completes the minimum service period specified in the referral announcement. Employees who directly control the hiring decision for the referred candidate may be excluded from receiving the bonus to avoid conflicts of interest.

3. Onboarding, Probation, Training, and Work Expectations

3.1 First-Day Onboarding

New employees are expected to complete identity and employment documentation, payroll setup, tax forms, emergency contact information, security acknowledgments, confidentiality agreements, and required policy acknowledgments. Employees receive access only to systems required for their role. Access may be granted progressively after the manager and system owner approve the request.

3.2 Orientation and Mandatory Training

Within the first 30 days, new employees must complete orientation and required courses covering code of conduct, information security, privacy, anti-money-laundering awareness, fraud prevention, workplace respect, records management, and any role-specific regulatory training. Employees who fail to complete mandatory training by the deadline may have system access suspended and may be subject to corrective action.

3.3 Probationary Period

Regular new hires generally complete a 90-day introductory probationary period. During this period, the manager evaluates attendance, job knowledge, quality of work, learning progress, teamwork, communication, customer focus, and compliance with Bank policies. The probation period may be extended once for up to 60 additional days when the employee needs more time to demonstrate consistent performance. Successful completion of probation does not create a guarantee of continued employment.

3.4 Standard Workweek and Attendance

The standard workweek for most full-time employees is 40 hours, normally spread across five workdays. Department schedules may vary because of branch operations, customer-support coverage, technology releases, month-end processing, or other business requirements. Employees are expected to be ready to work at their scheduled start time and to notify the manager as early as reasonably possible when an unexpected absence or late arrival occurs.

3.5 Hybrid and Remote Work Expectations

Employees working remotely must maintain a reliable internet connection, a private and professional work environment, and reasonable availability during agreed working hours. Bank data must be accessed only through approved devices, networks, applications, and security controls. Printing customer information at home is prohibited unless a specific business process has been approved. Remote employees may be required to report to an office for training, audits, major meetings, incident response, or other business needs.

3.6 Performance Management

Managers are expected to set clear goals and provide ongoing feedback. Formal performance reviews are normally conducted annually, with a midyear check-in encouraged. Performance may be evaluated using results, quality, risk management, customer outcomes, collaboration, leadership behaviors, compliance, and job-specific measures. An employee who is not meeting expectations may receive coaching, a documented performance improvement plan, reassignment of duties, or corrective action depending on the circumstances.

3.7 Outside Employment

Employees may engage in outside employment or business activities if those activities do not interfere with RKM Bank duties, misuse Bank information or resources, create a conflict of interest, compete improperly with the Bank, or damage the Bank relationship with customers or regulators. Employees in certain control, investment, procurement, or leadership roles may be required to obtain written approval before accepting outside work.

4. Workplace Conduct, Ethics, Security, and Confidentiality

4.1 Professional Conduct

Employees must treat customers, coworkers, vendors, and business partners with professionalism and respect. Threats, intimidation, bullying, discriminatory conduct, harassment, retaliation, deliberate humiliation, and disruptive behavior are not acceptable. Managers have an added responsibility to address conduct concerns promptly and to involve Human Resources when formal review is appropriate.

4.2 Conflicts of Interest and Gifts

Employees must avoid situations in which personal interests improperly influence, or appear to influence, business decisions. Employees may not approve transactions involving themselves or close relatives when an independent approval is required. Cash gifts from customers or vendors are prohibited. Non-cash gifts of modest value may be accepted only when lawful, infrequent, not intended to influence a decision, and consistent with the Bank gift and entertainment standard. Employees should disclose uncertain situations to Compliance.

4.3 Customer and Bank Information

Customer information, employee information, pricing, risk models, security procedures, source code, internal reports, strategic plans, and other non-public information must be protected. Employees may access confidential information only for legitimate job duties. Looking up the account of a family member, friend, celebrity, coworker, or other person without a valid business reason is prohibited even if the employee does not share the information with anyone else.

4.4 Passwords and Technology Use

Employees must use strong passwords or approved authentication methods, protect authentication tokens, and never share credentials. Bank devices are primarily for business use. Limited personal use may be allowed if it is lawful, brief, does not interfere with work, does not consume significant resources, and does not introduce security risk. Installing unapproved software, disabling security tools, sending sensitive Bank data to personal email, or storing confidential files in unapproved cloud services is prohibited.

4.5 Artificial Intelligence and External Tools

Employees may use approved artificial-intelligence tools only for authorized business purposes and in accordance with Bank security standards. Customer account data, authentication secrets, non-public financial information, regulated personal information, confidential source code, and restricted internal documents must not be entered into public AI services unless the service has been formally approved for that data classification. Employees remain responsible for reviewing AI-generated work for accuracy, bias, confidentiality, and compliance.

4.6 Records and Communications

Business records must be accurate, complete, and retained according to the Bank records schedule. Employees must not intentionally alter, conceal, backdate, destroy, or fabricate records to mislead customers, auditors, regulators, managers, or investigators. Business communications should be professional and should use approved channels when discussing confidential matters.

4.7 Reporting Concerns

Employees are encouraged to report suspected fraud, bribery, harassment, retaliation, financial manipulation, security breaches, privacy incidents, or other serious misconduct. Reports may be made to a manager, Human Resources, Compliance, Information Security, Internal Audit, or the Ethics channel. The Bank prohibits retaliation against an employee who raises a concern in good faith or participates honestly in an investigation.

5. Time Off, Holidays, and Leave Policies

5.1 Paid Time Off

Regular full-time employees receive 18 days of paid time off, or PTO, per calendar year during their first five completed years of service. Beginning in the sixth year of continuous service, the annual PTO allowance increases to 23 days. Beginning in the eleventh year, the allowance increases to 28 days. Employees hired during the year receive a prorated allowance. Part-time employees may receive prorated PTO based on scheduled hours. PTO should be requested in advance whenever the need is foreseeable and remains subject to manager approval based on staffing and business needs.

5.2 Carryover and Negative Balance

Employees may carry over up to five unused PTO days into the next calendar year. Carried days must normally be used by March 31 or they expire unless local law requires different treatment. Employees generally may not use more PTO than they have accrued or been granted. Human Resources may approve a temporary negative balance of up to three days for exceptional circumstances, with the understanding that future PTO accrual will first offset the negative amount.

5.3 Sick Leave

RKM Bank provides up to eight paid sick days per calendar year to regular full-time employees. Sick leave may be used for the employee own illness, medical appointment, preventive care, or to care for an immediate family member who is ill. When an absence lasts more than three consecutive scheduled workdays, the Bank may request appropriate documentation consistent with law. Sick leave is separate from PTO and is not paid out when employment ends unless required by law.

5.4 Holidays

The Bank publishes an annual holiday calendar. Corporate offices generally observe ten paid holidays each year. Branches and operations teams may remain open on some holidays and provide an alternate paid day off or other treatment permitted by law. Employees should confirm the schedule applicable to their location and department rather than assuming that every Bank location closes on the same dates.

5.5 Parental Leave

A regular full-time employee who has completed at least six months of service may receive up to eight weeks of paid parental leave following the birth, adoption, or placement of a child. Paid parental leave is intended for bonding and family transition. Where another statutory family or medical leave applies, the leaves may run concurrently when permitted by law. Employees should notify Human Resources at least 30 days in advance when the need for leave is foreseeable.

5.6 Bereavement Leave

Employees may receive up to five paid workdays following the death of a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, or legal guardian. Up to three paid workdays may be provided for the death of a sibling, grandparent, grandchild, parent-in-law, or comparable close family relationship. A manager and Human Resources may approve additional unpaid or PTO-supported time when travel, cultural practices, or unusual circumstances require more time.

5.7 Jury Duty and Military Leave

Employees summoned for jury duty should notify their manager promptly and provide the court notice when requested. The Bank will provide jury-duty leave and any pay continuation required by law or Bank program rules. Military leave and reemployment rights are administered in accordance with applicable law. Employees should contact Human Resources as early as practical to coordinate benefits and return-to-work arrangements.

6. Compensation, Payroll, Salary Review, and Salary Advance

6.1 Payroll

RKM Bank pays employees on a biweekly schedule, resulting in 26 regular pay periods in most years. Employees are responsible for reviewing pay statements and promptly reporting suspected errors. Direct deposit is the standard payment method where legally permitted. Required taxes, benefit elections, court-ordered deductions, and other authorized deductions may reduce net pay.

6.2 Overtime

Employees classified as non-exempt must accurately record all hours worked and are eligible for overtime pay as required by law. Overtime should be approved in advance by the manager, but an employee must still report all time actually worked even when advance approval was not obtained. Working off the clock, instructing another employee to underreport hours, or falsifying time records is prohibited.

6.3 Annual Salary Review

The Bank normally conducts a salary review once each year. A review does not guarantee an increase. Salary decisions may consider individual performance, current salary relative to the approved range, market conditions, internal equity, role scope, skills, budget availability, and Bank performance. Employees who joined very recently or who received a recent promotion may receive a prorated increase or may not be eligible for the current cycle.

6.4 Variable Pay and Bonuses

Some positions may be eligible for an annual incentive or performance bonus. Unless a written plan states otherwise, a target bonus is not guaranteed. Final awards may be affected by Bank performance, department results, individual performance, risk outcomes, conduct, compliance, and active employment requirements. Serious misconduct or significant control failures may reduce or eliminate an otherwise earned incentive.

6.5 Salary Advance Program

Regular full-time employees who have completed at least 12 months of continuous service may request a salary advance for an urgent and unforeseen financial need. The maximum advance is the lesser of 50 percent of one month of base salary or \$3,000. An employee may receive no more than two salary advances in any rolling 12-month period. Approval is not automatic and depends on eligibility, prior repayment history, applicable law, and Human Resources or Payroll review.

Approved salary advances are normally repaid through equal payroll deductions over a maximum of six months. The program is not intended to function as a recurring loan facility. Employees with an outstanding salary advance are generally not eligible for another advance. If employment ends before the advance is fully repaid, any legally permitted remaining balance may be deducted from final pay; otherwise the employee remains responsible for repayment under the signed advance agreement.

6.6 Business Expenses

Employees may be reimbursed for reasonable, necessary, and properly documented business expenses that comply with the travel and expense policy. Expenses should normally be submitted within 30 days. Personal expenses, duplicate claims, altered receipts, and expenses lacking a legitimate business purpose are not reimbursable. Corporate cards must not be used for personal purchases except in a genuine emergency followed by prompt disclosure and repayment.

7. Employee Benefits and Support Programs

7.1 Health Coverage

Eligible regular full-time employees may enroll in the Bank medical, dental, and vision plans. Coverage generally becomes effective on the first day of the month following 30 days of employment, subject to plan terms. Employees must make enrollment elections within the required enrollment window. Later changes are normally permitted only during annual open enrollment or after a qualifying life event such as marriage, divorce, birth, adoption, or loss of other coverage.

7.2 Retirement Savings Plan

Eligible employees may participate in the RKM Bank Retirement Savings Plan after 90 days of service. Employees may contribute a percentage of eligible pay subject to legal limits. The Bank provides a matching contribution equal to 100 percent of the employee contribution on the first 3 percent of eligible pay and 50 percent of the employee contribution on the next 2 percent. This means an employee who contributes at least 5 percent can receive a maximum Bank match equal to 4 percent of eligible pay, subject to plan terms and limits.

7.3 Life and Disability Insurance

The Bank provides basic employer-paid life insurance for eligible full-time employees in an amount equal to one times annual base salary, subject to plan maximums. Employees may be able to purchase supplemental life coverage. Short-term and long-term disability programs may provide partial income replacement when an eligible employee cannot work because of a qualifying medical condition. Waiting periods, benefit percentages, exclusions, and claim requirements are governed by the applicable plan documents.

7.4 Employee Assistance Program

The Employee Assistance Program, or EAP, provides confidential support resources for employees and eligible household members. Services may include short-term counseling, stress-management support, family-resource referrals, financial counseling, and legal-information services. Use of the EAP is voluntary. Managers are not normally informed that an employee used the service unless the employee authorizes disclosure or disclosure is legally required in an emergency.

7.5 Education and Certification Assistance

After six months of service, regular full-time employees may request reimbursement for approved job-related education or professional certification costs. The annual reimbursement limit is \$4,000 unless a department has approved a different program. The course or certification must have a reasonable relationship to the employee current or anticipated Bank responsibilities, and manager approval must be obtained before the employee incurs the expense. Proof of successful completion and eligible payment is required for reimbursement.

7.6 Wellness and Community Service

The Bank may offer wellness activities, preventive-health resources, and voluntary fitness initiatives. Regular full-time employees may also use up to eight paid hours per calendar year for an approved community-service activity with a qualified nonprofit organization. Community-service time must be approved in advance and cannot be used for political campaigning, personal fundraising, or activities that create a conflict of interest for the Bank.

8. Corrective Action, Grievances, Workplace Changes, and Separation

8.1 Corrective Action

When conduct or performance falls below expectations, the Bank may use coaching, verbal counseling, written warning, final written warning, performance improvement planning, suspension, reassignment, or termination. The Bank is not required to use every step or to use steps in a fixed order. Serious misconduct, including theft, fraud, intentional data misuse, workplace violence, material falsification, bribery, or deliberate security violations, may result in immediate termination subject to applicable law and investigation.

8.2 Employee Grievances

Employees who believe a workplace decision was unfair or inconsistent with policy are encouraged to raise the matter promptly. A concern may be discussed with the immediate manager, another manager, or Human Resources. Complaints involving harassment, retaliation, ethics, fraud, or a manager conflict may be raised directly with Human Resources, Compliance, or the Ethics channel. The Bank will review concerns as objectively as practical and may interview relevant individuals or examine records.

8.3 Resignation

Employees who choose to resign are requested to provide at least two weeks written notice. Employees in senior leadership, critical technology, control, audit, legal, or highly specialized positions are encouraged to provide four weeks notice when practical. The Bank may accept a resignation effective earlier than the proposed final date, subject to law. Accrued PTO treatment at separation depends on applicable law and the employee location.

8.4 Involuntary Separation

Employment may end because of performance, conduct, policy violation, position elimination, restructuring, attendance problems, inability to meet job requirements, or other lawful business reasons. When a position is eliminated, the Bank may consider alternative roles, notice, severance, or transition support based on the applicable program, employee eligibility, business circumstances, and local law. Severance is not automatically guaranteed by this handbook.

8.5 Final Pay and Benefits

Final wages will be paid in accordance with applicable law and the normal payroll process unless an earlier payment deadline applies. Employees must return Bank property, including computers, badges, cards, keys, records, security devices, documents, and other equipment. Benefit continuation, conversion options, retirement-plan treatment, and insurance termination dates are determined by the governing plan documents and legal requirements.

8.6 Exit Process and Continuing Obligations

Departing employees may be asked to complete an exit interview and provide current contact information for tax and benefit documents. Confidentiality, intellectual-property, records, non-solicitation, repayment, or other lawful obligations that survive employment remain in effect according to the applicable agreement. Former employees must not retain Bank or customer information after separation.

9. Retirement, Rehire, Policy Administration, and Practical Scenarios

9.1 Retirement

For internal workforce planning, an employee may notify Human Resources of an intended retirement date, but the Bank does not impose a mandatory retirement age except where specifically permitted by law for a particular role. Employees planning retirement are encouraged to provide at least 60 days notice so that benefits counseling, knowledge transfer, access changes, and succession planning can be coordinated. Retirement-plan distributions are governed by the plan document and applicable tax law, not by this handbook summary.

9.2 Retiree and Long-Service Recognition

Employees retiring after at least ten years of continuous RKM Bank service may be eligible for a long-service recognition award or retirement event under the program in effect at the time. Such recognition is discretionary and may change. Retired employees do not retain access to Bank systems, customer information, or confidential records merely because of former employment.

9.3 Rehire Eligibility

Former employees may be considered for rehire based on the circumstances of separation, prior performance, conduct history, repayment obligations, qualifications, and current business need. An employee terminated for fraud, theft, intentional data misuse, serious violence, or material dishonesty is normally ineligible for rehire. Employees who resigned in good standing may be eligible to apply for future roles without a fixed waiting period unless a specific agreement states otherwise.

9.4 Practical Policy Examples for Employees

Example A: An employee with three years of service receives 18 PTO days for a full calendar year, while an employee entering the sixth year of continuous service receives 23 days. Up to five unused PTO days may carry into the next year and normally expire after March 31 if not used.

Example B: A full-time employee who has worked for the Bank for 14 months experiences an unexpected emergency expense. If otherwise eligible, the employee may request a salary advance. If monthly base salary is \$5,000, 50 percent equals \$2,500, which is below the \$3,000 program cap. The maximum available advance in that example would therefore be \$2,500, subject to approval.

Example C: An employee asks an AI chatbot to summarize a customer complaint. If the chatbot is a public, unapproved AI service, the employee must not paste the customer account details or restricted internal information into it. The employee may use only an approved tool and must follow data-classification rules.

Example D: A new employee does not complete mandatory security training within the required first 30 days. The Bank may suspend access to certain systems until training is completed and may apply corrective action if the failure continues.

Example E: An employee resigns and gives two weeks notice but still owes part of an approved salary advance. Any remaining amount may be deducted from final wages only when legally permitted and covered by the employee authorization or agreement. If it cannot lawfully be deducted, the employee remains responsible for repayment.

9.5 Handbook Administration

Human Resources owns this handbook in coordination with Legal, Compliance, Information Security, Finance, Payroll, and business leaders. Plan documents, employment agreements, local policies, and applicable law may contain additional details or controlling terms. When there is a conflict between a benefit-plan document and this handbook summary, the governing plan document controls. Employees are expected to read policy updates and seek clarification before acting when a rule is unclear.

9.6 Employee Acknowledgment

Employees may be required to acknowledge electronically that they received and reviewed the handbook. An acknowledgment confirms receipt and understanding of the responsibility to follow applicable policies; it does not convert the handbook into an employment contract. Employees should retain access to the latest electronic version and review updates when Human Resources announces a change.